financing special farming schemes like hybrid seed production, animal husbandry, dairy farming, pisciculture, and poultry farming on an experimental basis. These small experiments provided the bank with a springboard to proceed to give production finance for current agricultural operations as well as for development of land and mechanization of farms. Finance was also provided for processing, storage, and marketing of agricultural produce. Care was taken to see that competition with co-operative institutions was avoided.[17]

The bank also took up financing of area development schemes. In Varanasi and Etah districts of Uttar Pradesh, for example, a total area of 320,000 acres was being brought under a comprehensive programme of agricultural development through intensive groundwater development for irrigation and a simultaneous supporting programme for land development, crop planning, allocation of fertilizers, pesticides, etc. on a priority basis. The bank also agreed to finance a scheme of hybrid seed farming over an area of 32,000 acres in the Terai region.[18]

TRAINING

Any organization is only as good as the people who man it. The bank too realized that it was as good or as bad as its thousands of employees made it. In keeping with this, the bank formulated and implemented well-conceived training programmes to raise productivity of the staff at all levels and to make them appreciate the social purposes of the bank.

For an enormous organization like the SBI it was imperative that the decisions taken by the top management were understood by the middle level managers who controlled and guided the field staff. Similarly, these middle level officers needed to be trained to act on their own initiative rather than being spoon-fed by their superiors. Development of supervisory and managerial personnel was accepted by the bank as one of its important programmes. The bank established a Staff Training College at Hyderabad and various zonal training schools in different parts of the country. Frequent seminars and short-term courses were held for middle level managers, which were also attended by the top management and in which free and uninhabited exchange of ideas was encouraged. The training facilities available at the Bankers' Training College of the RBI, the Administrative